



YOUR SMILE CONFIDENCE PROFILE

Choosing how much to change

The difference between a refresh and a transformation, how shade choice actually works, what each level costs in permanence rather than money, and how to land somewhere you will still like in ten years.

The Ready Refresher · A Smile Confidence guide · General information, not dental advice

The question is not whether. It is how far.

You are not coming from insecurity, so the usual framing does not apply to you. Your decision is one of degree, and degree is the part that is genuinely difficult to get right, because the pressure runs in one direction. Nobody in a consultation talks you down. The default drift is toward whiter, more uniform, and more.

It helps to think in three levels. A **refresh** is whitening, small reshaping, perhaps some bonding: reversible or nearly so, modest cost, and it makes your own smile tidier. A **refine** adds a small number of veneers to specific teeth, usually the ones that break the line. A **redesign** treats the whole visible smile as one unit and changes shade, shape, and proportion together.

The trade-off is not really money, it is permanence. Each level up involves more of your own tooth and commits you further. The right answer is genuinely personal, and the useful test is not what looks most impressive at the consultation. It is what you will still be comfortable with in ten years, when the fashion has moved.

Six things worth deciding deliberately

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 Decide your level before you hear the options

Refresh, refine, or redesign. Having a starting position makes it much easier to notice if you drift upward for reasons you have not examined.

2 Be careful with shade

The brightest available shade photographs dramatically and reads as artificial in person to some eyes. Ask to see the shade against your own skin and hair in daylight, not just on a shade card.

3 Ask what the conservative version would look like

Every good plan has one. Hearing it out loud is the simplest guard against doing more than you meant to, and a dentist comfortable describing it is a good sign.

4 Think about ten years, not ten days

Ask what maintenance looks like, what happens when something chips, and how the result ages. Permanence cuts both ways.

5

Use the trial smile to test the level, not just the shape

Ask to see more than one option if you are between levels. Living with a mock-up for a few days answers the question in a way deliberation cannot.

6

Decide what you want people to notice

Some people want to look like they have had something done. Some want the opposite. Both are legitimate, and saying which changes the design considerably.

The drift is real and it is worth naming. Most people who regret cosmetic work regret going further than they meant to, rather than not far enough. Not doing enough is fixable later. Enamel that has already been reduced is not. Where you are unsure, the smaller version is the one that keeps your options open.

Signs the level is being chosen rather than assumed

- You were offered a more conservative option, unprompted
- Shade was discussed against your face rather than only on a card
- The permanence of each level was explained clearly
- More than one version was shown at the trial stage
- Nobody treated the largest plan as the obvious one

HOW DR. MEHTA WORKS

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

Enhancing an already-good smile is finer work than rescuing a damaged one, because the margin for error is smaller and the person will notice everything. That is exactly the kind of work a small practice is built around.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

Bring these to your consultation

Fifteen minutes goes a lot further with a couple of specifics in hand. Turning up with none of them is fine too.

1 Your level, written down

Refresh, refine, or redesign, plus why. You can change your mind, but starting from your own position rather than the menu is worth a great deal.

2 Photographs in the light you care about

Daylight, and one taken on your phone. Those are the conditions you will judge the result in.

3 An honest note on how noticeable you want it

Subtle enough that nobody asks, or clearly different. There is no wrong answer, but there is a wrong result if nobody asks the question.

Fifteen minutes, free, plus a preview of your smile

Dr. Mehta will show you what each level actually looks like for your teeth, including the conservative version, with a rendered preview so you can judge it rather than imagine it.

Book your free 15 minutes

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Nothing is done to your teeth at this appointment, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about cosmetic dental treatment. It is not dental advice, it is not a treatment plan, and it is not a comment on any other practice. What is achievable for your teeth depends on an in-person examination, and results differ from person to person. Any images you are shown are an illustration of a possible outcome, not a promise of one. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.